

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL HEALTH LICENSURE
STATE OF OKLAHOMA

**STATE OF OKLAHOMA, ex rel.,
STATE BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL
HEALTH LICENSURE,**
Petitioner,

Complaint No. 2025-LPC-779

vs.

**RICO CHILDS,
LPC, LICENSE NO. 7391**
Respondent.



**ORDER OF REVOCATION OF
PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR LICENSE**

This matter came on for hearing before the State Board of Behavioral Health Licensure (“the Board”) on February 6, 2026, at Oklahoma Office of Attorney General, 313 N.E. 21st Street, Susan Loving – CR 1008, Oklahoma City, Oklahoma, pursuant to notice given as required by law and rules of the Board.

Liz Stevens, Assistant Attorney General, appeared on behalf of Petitioner. Respondent appeared in person pro se. Ms. Stevens for Petitioner and Respondent are hereinafter referred to as the Parties. The parties agreed to the admission of the following Exhibits, which were admitted into the record: State Exhibits 3 and 4 and Respondent Exhibit 1. The Board makes the following findings of fact, conclusions of law and orders:

FINDINGS OF FACT

1. Petitioner is a state agency with jurisdictional authority to regulate Licensed Professional Counselors, pursuant to 59 O.S. §§ 1901, *et seq.*
2. Respondent is a Licensed Professional Counselor in the State of Oklahoma, holding License Number 7391, and was licensed on or about December 6, 2019.
3. On November 3, 2025, Respondent pled Guilty to one (1) count of Medicaid Fraud in violation of 56 O.S. § 1005, Oklahoma County case number CF-2025-1454.
4. Respondent was sentenced to a 2-year deferred sentence, prevented from billing Medicaid for duration of the sentence, and ordered to pay restitution and other costs.
5. The offer of proof for the guilty plea states that “[o]n or about January 11, 2020, and September 20, 2023, in Oklahoma County, OK [Respondent] willfully and knowingly

submitted false claims of payment to the Oklahoma Medicaid Program in the aggregate amount of more than \$2500 for services not rendered.”

6. Said conduct, if proven, would constitute violations of the Oklahoma Licensed Professional Counselors Act, and the applicable Oklahoma Administrative Rules.

CONCLUSIONS OF LAW

1. The Board has jurisdiction over this matter and Respondent pursuant to 59 O.S. § 1905(B)(4) of the Licensed Professional Counselors Act.
2. Furthermore, according to the Licensed Professional Counselors Act, 59 O.S. § 1912(A):

The State Board of Behavioral Health Licensure may deny, revoke, suspend or place on probation any license or specialty designation issued pursuant to the provisions of the Licensed Professional Counselors Act to a licensed professional counselor, if the person has:

 - (2) Engaged in fraud or deceit in connection with services rendered or in establishing needed qualifications pursuant to the provisions of this act;
 - (4) Engaged in unprofessional conduct as defined by the rules established by the Board;
 - (5) Engaged in negligence or wrongful actions in the performance of his or her duties;
3. According to 59 O.S. § 1913.1 and OAC 86:10-29-14, any person who is determined by the Board to have violated any provision of the LPC Act or any Rule related to licensed professional counseling, may be subject to an administrative penalty, not to exceed \$10,000 for any related series of violations.
4. Respondent’s Plea of Guilty to one (1) count of Medicaid Fraud in violation of 56 O.S. § 1005 shows that Respondent engaged in fraud or deceit in connection with services rendered, that Respondent engaged in unprofessional conduct as defined by the rules established by the Board, and that Respondent engaged in negligence or wrongful actions in the performance of her duties in violation of 59 O.S. § 1912 (A)(3),(5)&(6).
5. Respondent’s Plea of Guilty to one (1) count of Medicaid Fraud in violation of 56 O.S. § 1005 shows that Respondent violated OAC 86:10-3-1, which provides that LPCs shall not participate in, condone, or be associated with dishonesty, fraud, deceit or misrepresentation.
6. Respondent’s Plea of Guilty to one (1) count of Medicaid Fraud in violation of 56 O.S. § 1005 shows that Respondent violated OAC 86:10-3-4(a), which provides that it is unprofessional conduct for an LPC to plead guilty to a state or federal statute if the violation directly relates to the duties and responsibilities of the counselor and poses a reasonable threat to public safety.

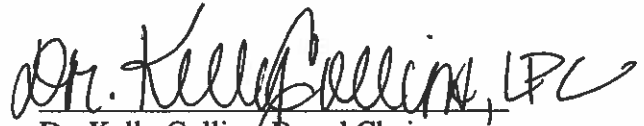
ORDER

IT IS THEREFORE ORDERED by the State Board of Behavioral Health Licensure as follows:

1. The Professional Counselor license of Rico Childs, license no. 7391 is hereby REVOKED and the Board assesses a \$2,000.00 administrative penalty.

This Order is subject to review and approval by the Oklahoma Attorney General, pursuant to Executive Order 2023-13, and this Order shall become final upon completion of the review by the Oklahoma Attorney General unless disapproved, in which case this Order shall be null and void.

Dated this 9 day of February, 2026.


Dr. Kelly Collins, Board Chair
State Board of Behavioral Health Licensure

Certificate of Service

This is to certify that on the 9 day of February 2026, the foregoing instrument was transmitted as indicated, postage prepaid, to the following:

U.S. Certified Mail return receipt requested

Rico Childs
9555 Bear Creek Rd.
Guthrie, OK 73044
Respondent


Eric Ashmore, Executive Director